

Job Search Strategy

Litmus V2 career/resume RAG knowledge-base document.

Hidden job market

The hidden job market refers to openings filled through networking, referrals, or internal promotion rather than public advertising.

Networking

Networking can surface hidden opportunities and provide internal referrals. Referrals frequently receive priority screening compared with general careers-page applications.

Informational interview

An informational interview is a casual, low-pressure conversation with a professional to learn about a role or industry, not to directly ask for a job.

LinkedIn updates

During an active search, keep LinkedIn continuously updated and ideally revisit it every few weeks, including the headline, summary, and recent accomplishments.

Targeted applications

Highly targeted applications allow resumes and cover letters to be tailored closely to each role, improving ATS matching and application quality. Generic mass applications often have lower response rates per application.

Career changers

Career changers should emphasize transferable skills, relevant projects or certifications, and a clear narrative connecting previous experience to the new field.

First step

Begin with self-assessment: clarify career goals, target roles, target industries, and non-negotiables before applying.